

PROPRIETY MATTERS

Though she earned her BA and law degrees from Delhi, Justice Nagarathna chose to begin her legal career from Karnataka. Reason? She did not want to operate from the official residence of her father, Justice E.S. Venkataramiah, a Supreme Court judge then, who went on to become the 19th Chief Justice of India

deciding a divorce case, she called out the entrenched patriarchy in India, saying, "...the society does not know how to treat an empowered woman."

A mother of two daughters, Justice Nagarathna advocates equal rights for women, not sympathy. Elder daughter Nayana Tara B.G. has followed in her footsteps, and has been practising law in Bengaluru since 2014. Younger daughter Prerana B.G. is a filmmaker. Justice Nagarathna acknowledges the support of her spouse Gopala Krishna, who is working as registrar (administration) at M.S. Ramaiah University of Applied Sciences, Bengaluru.

Following her elevation to the Supreme Court in August 2021, Justice Nagarathna is in line to become the 55th CJI in 2027, and hence could very well be the first woman to hold the top judicial office. For now, all eyes are on this independent-minded jurist and her journey to the top post. ■

-Kaushik Deka